



10 CFR 50.73

RA23-067

December 4, 2023

U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission
ATTN: Document Control Desk
Washington, DC 20555-0001

LaSalle County Station, Unit 1
Renewed Facility Operating License No. NPF-11
NRC Docket No. 50-373

Subject: Licensee Event Report 2023-002-00, Turbine Stop Valve Limit Switch
Failure due to Lubricant Degradation

In accordance with 10 CFR 50.73(a)(2)(i)(B), Exelon Generation Company, LLC
(EGC) is submitting Licensee Event Report (LER) Number 2023-002-00 for LaSalle
County Station, Unit 1.

There are no regulatory commitments in this letter. Should you have any questions
concerning this report, please contact Ms. Laura Ekern, Regulatory Assurance Manager,
at (815) 415-2800.

Respectfully,

Christopher J. Smith
Plant Manager
LaSalle County Station

Enclosure: Licensee Event Report

cc: Regional Administrator – NRC Region III
NRC Senior Resident Inspector – LaSalle County Station



LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)

(See Page 2 for required number of digits/characters for each block)
(See NUREG-1022, R.3 for instruction and guidance for completing this form
<http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/doc-collections/nuregs/staff/sr1022/r3/>)

Estimated burden per response to comply with this mandatory collection request: 80 hours. Reported lessons learned are incorporated into the licensing process and fed back to industry. Send comments regarding burden estimate to the FOIA, Library, and Information Collections Branch (T-6 A10M), U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission, Washington, DC 20555-0001, or by e-mail to InfoCollections@nrc.gov, and the OMB reviewer at: OMB Office of Information and Regulatory Affairs, (3150-0104), Attn: Desk Officer for the Nuclear Regulatory Commission, 725 17th Street NW, Washington, DC 20503, email: omb_submission@omb.eop.gov. The NRC may not conduct or sponsor, and a person is not required to respond to, a collection of information unless the document requesting or requiring the collection displays a currently valid OMB control number.

1. Facility Name

LaSalle County Station, Unit 1

☒ 050
☐ 052

2. Docket Number

00373

3. Page

1 OF 4

4. Title

Turbine Stop Valve Limit Switch Failure due to Lubricant Degradation

5. Event Date			6. LER Number			7. Report Date			8. Other Facilities Involved		
Month	Day	Year	Year	Sequential Number	Revision No.	Month	Day	Year	Facility Name	☐ 050	Docket Number
10	18	2023	2023	- 002 -	00	12	04	2023	NA	☐ 050	NA
									NA	☐ 052	NA

9. Operating Mode	1	10. Power Level	100 percent
-------------------	---	-----------------	-------------

11. This Report is Submitted Pursuant to the Requirements of 10 CFR §: (Check all that apply)

☐ 10 CFR Part 20	☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(vi)	☐ 10 CFR Part 50	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(ii)(A)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(viii)(A)	☐ 73.1200(a)
☐ 20.2201(b)	☐ 20.2203(a)(3)(i)	☐ 50.36(c)(1)(i)(A)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(ii)(B)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(viii)(B)	☐ 73.1200(b)
☐ 20.2201(d)	☐ 20.2203(a)(3)(ii)	☐ 50.36(c)(1)(ii)(A)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(iii)	☐ 73.73(a)(2)(ix)(A)	☐ 73.1200(c)
☐ 20.2203(a)(1)	☐ 20.2203(a)(4)	☐ 50.36(c)(2)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(iv)(A)	☐ 73.71(a)(2)(x)	☐ 73.1200(d)
☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(i)	☐ 10 CFR Part 21	☐ 50.46(a)(3)(ii)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(A)	☐ 10 CFR Part 73	☐ 73.1200(e)
☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(ii)	☐ 21.2(c)	☐ 50.69(g)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(B)	☐ 73.77(a)(1)	☐ 73.1200(f)
☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(iii)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(A)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(C)	☐ 73.77(a)(2)(i)	☐ 73.1200(g)
☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(iv)		☒ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(B)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(v)(D)	☐ 73.77(a)(2)(ii)	☐ 73.1200(h)
☐ 20.2203(a)(2)(v)		☐ 50.73(a)(2)(i)(C)	☐ 50.73(a)(2)(vii)		

☐ OTHER (Specify here, in abstract, or NRC 366A).

12. Licensee Contact for this LER

Licensee Contact

Joseph Reda, Operations Director

Phone Number (include area code)

(815) 415-2200

13. Complete One Line for each Component Failure Described in this Report

Cause	System	Component	Manufacturer	Reportable to IRIS	Cause	System	Component	Manufacturer	Reportable to IRIS
B	TA	33	N007	Y	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA

14. Supplemental Report Expected

☒ No☐ Yes (If yes, complete 15. Expected Submission Date)

15. Expected Submission Date

Month	Day	Year

16. Abstract (Limit to 1560 spaces, i.e., approximately 15 single-spaced typewritten lines)

On 9/7/2023 during surveillances of the turbine stop valves (TSV), limit switch 1C71-N006G failed. The component was sent offsite for failure analysis. Component failure analysis was complete on 10/18/2023 and determined that the cause was attributed to degradation of switch lubricant which established firm evidence that a past inoperability condition existed.

The component 1C71-N006G is the TSV-4 closure Reactor Protection System (RPS) channel A2 scram limit switch. This device is required by technical specifications to support LCO 3.3.1.1 function 8 (RPS) and LCO 3.3.4.1 (End of Cycle - Recirculation Pump Trip or EOC-RPT). Each TSV position is monitored by two limit switches (for TSV-4, A2 and B2 channels). This condition results in the TSV-4 input to RPS A2 as well as one channel of the EOC-RPT trip being INOPERABLE. The appropriate LCO Conditions and Required Actions were entered and tracked. The RPS and EOC-RPT functions were maintained due to the redundant channels remaining OPERABLE. There were no reportability thresholds applicable to this issue at the time of the event, and there was no loss of safety function. The condition is reportable in accordance with 10 CFR 50.73(a)(2)(i)(B) for operation or condition prohibited by Technical Specifications.

Immediate corrective actions were taken to replace the component and restore the associated channel to OPERABLE.

**LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)
CONTINUATION SHEET**

(See NUREG-1022, R.3 for instruction and guidance for completing this form
<http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/doc-collections/nuregs/staff/sr1022/r3/>)

Estimated burden per response to comply with this mandatory collection request: 80 hours. Reported lessons learned are incorporated into the licensing process and fed back to industry. Send comments regarding burden estimate to the FOIA, Library, and Information Collections Branch (T-6 A10M), U. S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission, Washington, DC 20555-0001, or by e-mail to Infocollections.Resource@nrc.gov, and the OMB reviewer at: OMB Office of Information and Regulatory Affairs, (3150-0104), Attn: Desk Officer for the Nuclear Regulatory Commission, 725 17th Street NW, Washington, DC 20503; e-mail: omb_submission@omb.eop.gov. The NRC may not conduct or sponsor, and a person is not required to respond to, a collection of information unless the document requesting or requiring the collection displays a currently valid OMB control number.

1. FACILITY NAME LaSalle County Station, Unit 1	☒ 050	2. DOCKET NUMBER 00373	3. LER NUMBER				
	☐ 052		<table border="1"><thead><tr><th>YEAR</th><th>SEQUENTIAL NUMBER</th><th>REV</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2023</td><td>- 002</td><td>- 00</td></tr></tbody></table>	YEAR	SEQUENTIAL NUMBER	REV	2023
YEAR	SEQUENTIAL NUMBER	REV					
2023	- 002	- 00					

NARRATIVE**Plant and System Identification**

LaSalle Country Station Unit 1 is a General Electric Boiling Water Reactor with 3546 Megawatts Thermal Rated Core Power. The affected system was the main turbine system. The affected component was the turbine stop valve (TSV) limit switch 1C71-N006G. This is the limit switch for the TSV number 4 Closure Reactor Protection System (RPS) A2 channel.

Condition Prior to Event

Unit(s): 1	Date: October 18, 2023	Time: 00:00 CDT
Reactor Mode(s): 1	Mode(s) Name: Power Operation	Power Level: 100 percent

Description

On 09/07/2023 the limit switch on Unit 1 TSV-4 failed to actuate during surveillance testing. The limit switch is normally held in the actuated position during unit operation and only allowed to return to the relaxed, shelf state position, upon closure of the turbine stop valve. The failed limit switch, 1C71-N006G, was replaced and sent offsite for component testing and failure analysis. The component failure analysis (documented in report dated October 18, 2023) verified the limit switch malfunction and determined the cause was attributed to degradation of switch lubricant.

Cause

Analysis attributed the failure to the switch shaft and shaft bearing degraded lubrication causing the shaft to bind in the actuated (Turbine Stop Valve open) position.

The cause of the limit switch lubricant degradation was elevated temperatures due to a steam leak in close proximity. This steam leak has circumvented previous corrective actions such as use of high temperature switches and limit switch housing modifications.

Reportability and Safety Analysis

The component 1C71-N006G is the TSV-4 Closure RPS channel A2 scram limit switch. This device is required to be OPERABLE per LCO 3.3.1.1 Function 8 (RPS) and LCO 3.3.4.1 (EOC-RPT). TSV-4 was fully closed during the surveillance, which should have resulted in the 1C71-N006G switch being open. Each TSV position is monitored by two limit switches (for TSV-4, A2 and B2 channels). This condition results in the TSV-4 input to RPS A2 as well as one channel of the EOC-RPT trip being INOPERABLE. The appropriate LCO Conditions and Required Actions were entered and tracked. The RPS and EOC-RPT functions were maintained due to the redundant channels remaining OPERABLE. There were no reportability thresholds applicable to this issue at the time of the event, and there was no loss of safety function.

Upon receipt of the failure analysis on October 18, 2023, the station was made aware that a past inoperability period existed from the test failure that occurred on September 7, 2023. The inoperability period was greater than allowed by TS LCO 3.3.1.1 and 3.3.4.1, as indicated below. This event is reportable in accordance with 10 CFR 50.73(a)(2)(i)(B) as a condition prohibited by the plant's TS.

- LCO 3.3.1.1 requires that the RPS instrumentation for each function is OPERABLE, and Condition A applies to one or more required channels being inoperable requires that the channel or its associated trip system is placed in trip within 12 hours. In this case, the station had exceeded the completion time of 12 hours, when the

**LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER)
CONTINUATION SHEET**

(See NUREG-1022, R.3 for instruction and guidance for completing this form
<http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/doc-collections/nuregs/staff/sr1022/r3/>)

Estimated burden per response to comply with this mandatory collection request: 80 hours. Reported lessons learned are incorporated into the licensing process and fed back to industry. Send comments regarding burden estimate to the FOIA, Library, and Information Collections Branch (T-6 A10M), U. S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission, Washington, DC 20555-0001, or by e-mail to Infocollections.Resource@nrc.gov, and the OMB reviewer at: OMB Office of Information and Regulatory Affairs, (3150-0104), Attn: Desk Officer for the Nuclear Regulatory Commission, 725 17th Street NW, Washington, DC 20503; e-mail: oir_submission@omb.eop.gov. The NRC may not conduct or sponsor, and a person is not required to respond to, a collection of information unless the document requesting or requiring the collection displays a currently valid OMB control number.

1. FACILITY NAME LaSalle County Station, Unit 1	☒ 050	2. DOCKET NUMBER 00373	3. LER NUMBER				
	☐ 052		<table border="1"><thead><tr><th>YEAR</th><th>SEQUENTIAL NUMBER</th><th>REV</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2023</td><td>- 002</td><td>- 00</td></tr></tbody></table>	YEAR	SEQUENTIAL NUMBER	REV	2023
YEAR	SEQUENTIAL NUMBER	REV					
2023	- 002	- 00					

NARRATIVE

malfunctioning channel was found inoperable during September 2023 surveillance testing. In addition, LCO 3.3.1.1 Condition D was not entered for the Completion Time of Condition A not met.

- LCO 3.3.4.1 requires that the EOC-RPT instrumentation is OPERABLE, which includes two channels of TSV closure and TCV fast closure or Minimum Critical Power Ratio (MCPR) limits are applied.

Corrective Actions

Corrective actions taken in response to the conditions were:

- A work order was completed to replace the component, and to restore the associated channel to OPERABLE.
- Performed component failure analysis at off-site testing facility.
- Testing frequency was increased from 90 days to 45 days for the Unit 1 RPS A channel switches. Testing frequency will be reevaluated following steam leak repairs scheduled to occur in the next Unit 1 refueling outage.

Previous OccurrencesUnit 1 LER 373-2019-001-00

During quarterly surveillances of TSV limit switch 1C71-N006C, the component exhibited degraded performance on May 20, 2018 and a failure on September 9, 2018. The component was replaced; and subsequent component failure analysis determined the cause was attributed to degradation of the switch lubricant due to exposure from a high temperature environment, which established firm evidence that the sluggish performance exhibited in May 2018 was related to the failure in September 2018 and that a past inoperability condition existed. Immediate corrective actions were taken to replace the component and restore the associated channel to OPERABLE. Additional actions included performance of a causal investigation, identification of a new limit switch model that has greater heat tolerance, with a component replacement schedule starting in 2019.

Unit 1 LER 373-2019-002-00

On March 23, 2019, during quarterly scram functional surveillances of turbine stop valves (TSV), the limit switch associated with TSV number 3 failed to return to shelf state when the lever arm was released. The failed component was replaced and sent offsite for component testing and failure analysis. The component failure analysis completed on May 3, 2019 determined the cause was attributed to insufficient lubrication in the shaft to bushing section of the limit switch. This established firm evidence that the failure mechanism and past inoperability condition may have existed since its last successful surveillance on December 15, 2018. Immediate corrective actions were taken to replace the component and restore the associated channel to OPERABLE. Additional actions included performance of a component failure analysis and to complete scheduled limit switch replacements of the current model with a new limit switch model that has greater heat tolerance.

Unit 2 LER 374-2022-002-00

On June 13, 2020, during functional testing surveillances of the turbine stop valves (TSV), the limit switch associated with TSV number 4 failed to return to shelf state when the lever arm was released. The failed component was replaced in the next available outage and sent offsite for component testing and failure analysis. The component failure analysis completed on March 24, 2021 found only a small amount of grease on the internal components. It was determined the switch failed due to dried out and gritty grease, likely due to a missing boot which could have caused the limit switch to dry out. Immediate corrective actions were taken to restore the associated channel to OPERABLE.



LICENSEE EVENT REPORT (LER) CONTINUATION SHEET

(See NUREG-1022, R.3 for instruction and guidance for completing this form
<http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/doc-collections/nuregs/staff/sr1022/r3/>)

Estimated burden per response to comply with this mandatory collection request: 80 hours. Reported lessons learned are incorporated into the licensing process and fed back to industry. Send comments regarding burden estimate to the FOIA, Library, and Information Collections Branch (T-6 A10M), U. S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission, Washington, DC 20555-0001, or by e-mail to Infocollections.Resource@nrc.gov, and the OMB reviewer at: OMB Office of Information and Regulatory Affairs, (3150-0104), Attn: Desk Officer for the Nuclear Regulatory Commission, 725 17th Street NW, Washington, DC 20503; e-mail: oina_submission@omb.eop.gov. The NRC may not conduct or sponsor, and a person is not required to respond to, a collection of information unless the document requesting or requiring the collection displays a currently valid OMB control number.

1. FACILITY NAME

LaSalle County Station, Unit 1

☒ 050

☐ 052

2. DOCKET NUMBER

00373

3. LER NUMBER

YEAR	SEQUENTIAL NUMBER	REV
2023	- 002	- 00

NARRATIVE

Unit 1 LER 373-2022-001-00

On 12/4/21 during surveillances of TSV limit switches, 1C71-N006C failed. Component failure analysis was complete on 2/4/2022 and determined that the cause was attributed to degradation of switch lubricant which established firm evidence that a past inoperability condition existed. Immediate corrective actions were taken to replace the component and restore the associated channel to OPERABLE. Additional corrective actions included actions generated for Engineering to evaluation the surveillance frequency to determine if a frequency reduction to quarterly is appropriate.

Component Failure Data

Manufacturer: NAMCO Controls Corporation

Device: Unit 1 Turbine Stop Valve limit switch (Model: EA700-80154)

Component ID: 1C71-N006G, Unit 1 Turbine Stop Valve Position Switch (Cat. ID 1791228)